

Human Growth and Development

ISC 640

Oral Exam

Enrolled

This course prepares students in supporting faith-based, nonprofit, community organizations' missions.

Dr. Felix Kiplangat

Summer 2026

Master

3 Credits

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Assignments

Assignment 1: Developmental Theory Analysis

 AI Grading

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Developmental Theory Analysis Read Module 2 and complete... Write a 1,000-word paper that addresses the following: a. Explain the purpose of developmental theories. b. Compare three major theories of human growth and development. c. Discuss the strengths and limitations of each theory. d. Explain how these theories can be applied in counseling or another helping profession. e. Describe how a Christian worldview complements the study of developmental theories. Assignment Requirements APA 7th edition formatting 1000-word (excluding title and reference pages) Minimum of 5 scholarly sources Include at least two biblical scriptures Proper in-text citations and reference list

 Due 14 days ago (Aug 15, 4:59 AM) – Late submission accepted

 100 pts



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Assignment 2: Child Development

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READ MODULE 3 Child Development Case Study (3–4 Pages) Select a child between birth and six years of age and write a 3–4 page developmental assessment that addresses the following: Describe the child's stage of development. Identify major physical, cognitive, emotional, and social milestones. Discuss factors that may positively or negatively influence the child's development. Explain the importance of attachment and family relationships. Recommend strategies that parents or caregivers can use to promote healthy development. Integrate biblical principles that support nurturing and protecting children.

 Due 1 day ago (Aug 27, 8:59 AM) — Late submission accepted 100 pts

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Assignment 3: Navigating Adulthood: Relationships, Career, Family, Purpose, and Healthy Development

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READ MODULE 5 Adult Development Across Early and Middle Adulthood Assignment Title Navigating Adulthood: Relationships, Career, Family, Purpose, and Healthy Development Assignment Overview Adulthood is a complex period of human development involving significant changes in relationships, career, family responsibilities, emotional maturity, physical health, leadership, and personal purpose. Early adulthood often centers on establishing independence, developing intimate relationships, beginning or advancing a career, and making major decisions about marriage and family. Middle adulthood frequently introduces additional responsibilities involving leadership, parenting, mentoring, caregiving, health changes, work-life balance, and reflection upon one's purpose and contribution to future generations. For this major assignment, students will complete a comprehensive Adult Development Case Study and Analysis examining an adult experiencing significant developmental responsibilities or life transitions. Students will apply developmental concepts, including Erikson's Intimacy versus Isolation and Generativity versus Stagnation, while analyzing the physical, cognitive, emotional, social, occupational, and spiritual dimensions of adulthood. The assignment should demonstrate that adult development is influenced not by one factor but by the interaction of relationships, career, family, health, emotional intelligence, responsibilities, life transitions, purpose, and available support

systems. Assignment Requirements Prepare a 2,500–3,000-word academic paper based on a fictional adult case you develop or an adult case provided by your instructor. Your individual should be experiencing either early adulthood or middle adulthood. The paper must use appropriate academic headings, but all sections must be written in complete, well-developed paragraph form rather than bullet points.

Section 1: Introduction and Adult Case Profile Introduce the adult you will analyze. Provide sufficient background to understand the individual's current life circumstances. Identify whether the individual is experiencing early adulthood or middle adulthood and explain why this developmental stage is appropriate. Describe relevant aspects of the individual's life, such as age, relationships, marriage or partnership status, parenting responsibilities, education, employment, career goals, family responsibilities, health, community involvement, and major life transitions. Conclude the introduction by identifying the primary developmental challenges that will be examined throughout your paper.

Section 2: Major Developmental Tasks of Adulthood Analyze the major developmental tasks associated with your individual's stage of adulthood. If your individual is in early adulthood, consider the development of independence, intimate relationships, career establishment, marriage, parenting, financial responsibility, emotional maturity, and personal identity. If your individual is in middle adulthood, consider career advancement or transition, leadership, parenting, mentoring, caregiving, physical changes, work-life balance, life satisfaction, and developing a greater sense of purpose. Explain which developmental tasks are particularly important for your case and how successfully the individual is navigating them.

Section 3: Erikson's Psychosocial Development Apply Erik Erikson's theory of psychosocial development to your case. If the individual is in early adulthood, analyze Intimacy versus Isolation. Explain how the individual's ability to establish close, trusting, and meaningful relationships contributes to healthy development. If the individual is in middle adulthood, analyze Generativity versus Stagnation. Explain whether the individual is contributing to other people through parenting, leadership, mentoring, professional service, community involvement, ministry, or other meaningful activities. Discuss what could happen developmentally if the individual struggles with intimacy, isolation, generativity, or stagnation.

Section 4: Relationships, Marriage, and Parenting Analyze the role of relationships in the individual's adult development. Discuss the importance of healthy communication, trust, emotional support, appropriate boundaries, conflict resolution, and mutual responsibility. If your case involves marriage or a committed relationship, explain how that relationship influences the individual's development and well-being. If the individual is a parent, examine how parenting responsibilities affect emotional development, career decisions, finances, relationships, and personal priorities. Your analysis should recognize that adults may follow different relationship and family pathways and should not assume that marriage or parenting is required for healthy adult development.

Section 5: Career Development and Work-Life Balance Examine the individual's career development. Discuss how employment can influence identity, financial stability, personal achievement, social relationships, purpose, and life satisfaction. Identify any occupational

challenges affecting your individual, such as career uncertainty, unemployment, professional advancement, workplace stress, career transition, leadership responsibilities, or dissatisfaction. Then examine work-life balance. Explain how the individual is managing competing responsibilities involving career, relationships, family, health, community involvement, rest, and personal development. Recommend strategies that could create a healthier balance.

Section 6: Emotional Intelligence and Adult Well-Being Analyze the importance of emotional intelligence during adulthood. Discuss the individual's ability to recognize and regulate emotions, demonstrate empathy, communicate effectively, respond to conflict, manage stress, and maintain healthy relationships. Explain how greater emotional maturity could improve the individual's personal relationships, professional effectiveness, parenting, leadership, or decision-making. Identify practical strategies that could strengthen emotional well-being.

Section 7: Physical Development and Healthy Aging Discuss the physical-development factors affecting the individual. If appropriate to the case, examine changes associated with middle adulthood, including energy levels, physical fitness, metabolism, sleep, menopause, or other age-related transitions. Discuss the importance of healthy aging and identify behaviors that could contribute to long-term physical and emotional wellness. Your analysis should consider the importance of appropriate healthcare, nutrition, physical activity, sleep, stress management, and other healthy lifestyle practices. Avoid treating normal developmental changes as illnesses or assuming that every adult experiences aging in the same way.

Section 8: Caregiving, Stress, and Midlife Transition If applicable to your case, analyze caregiver stress. Middle-aged adults may simultaneously manage employment, parenting, relationships, and responsibilities for aging family members. Explain how competing responsibilities could affect emotional health, relationships, finances, and physical well-being. Also examine the concept of midlife transition. Discuss how adults may reevaluate career choices, relationships, accomplishments, priorities, health, spirituality, and future goals during middle adulthood. Explain how such reflection could become an opportunity for healthy growth rather than simply being viewed as a crisis.

Section 9: Leadership, Mentoring, and Generativity Examine the adult's opportunities for leadership and mentoring. Discuss how adults can contribute to the development of younger generations through professional leadership, parenting, education, ministry, community service, volunteering, coaching, or mentoring. Explain how these activities relate to Erikson's concept of generativity. Identify at least two realistic ways your individual could use personal experience, professional knowledge, abilities, or resources to contribute to others.

Section 10: Protective Factors and Support Strategies Identify the individual's major strengths and protective factors. These might include supportive relationships, education, financial resources, faith, coping skills, employment, community connections, emotional intelligence, professional skills, resilience, or access to services. Then identify appropriate counseling, educational, professional, family, community, or other support strategies that could promote healthier adult development. Your recommendations should address the individual's specific circumstances rather than providing generic advice.

Section 11: Purpose, Stewardship, and Life Satisfaction Analyze the concepts of purpose, stewardship, and life satisfaction. Discuss what currently gives the individual a sense of meaning and whether the individual's lifestyle reflects personal values and priorities. Explain how adulthood can involve a gradual movement from focusing primarily on individual achievement toward considering one's responsibility and contribution to others. Discuss how responsible stewardship of time, abilities, relationships, resources, professional opportunities, and leadership responsibilities could contribute to greater purpose and life satisfaction.

Section 12: Biblical Integration and Purposeful Living Examine adult development from a Christian perspective. Discuss how biblical principles can guide adults toward responsibility, healthy relationships, service, stewardship, wisdom, perseverance, leadership, and purposeful living. Include at least three relevant Scripture passages and explain how each applies to your case. Do not simply quote Scripture. Explain how the biblical principles could practically influence the individual's relationships, career decisions, family responsibilities, leadership, health, or sense of purpose.

Section 13: Personal and Professional Reflection Conclude your assignment with a thoughtful reflection addressing what you have learned about adult development. Within your discussion, consider the following questions: How does early adulthood differ from middle adulthood? Why are healthy relationships important throughout adulthood? How can career and family responsibilities influence personal development? How can counselors or helping professionals support adults experiencing major life transitions? What does it mean to live a purposeful and responsible life during adulthood? Finally, explain how understanding adult development could influence the way you work with adults in your future professional, ministry, counseling, educational, healthcare, or community role.

Research Requirements Students must incorporate a minimum of six credible scholarly or professional sources addressing adult development, relationships, career development, Erikson's psychosocial theory, emotional well-being, aging, family development, or related concepts. Biblical references may be used in addition to the required academic sources but do not count toward the six-source minimum. All sources must be appropriately cited in the paper and included on the reference page.

Formatting Requirements The completed assignment should be 2,500–3,000 words, excluding the title and reference pages. Use APA 7th edition, double spacing, a 12-point academic font, 1-inch margins, appropriate section headings, in-text citations, and a complete reference page. All sections must be written in well-developed academic paragraph form rather than as bullet-point responses.

 Due about 20 hours ago (Aug 27, 11:59 PM) — Late submission accepted

 200 pts

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Assignment 4: Human Growth and Development: Lifespan Integration and Professional Application

AI Grading

Online Text

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READ MODULE 8 Human Growth and Development: Lifespan Integration and Professional Application Assignment Overview Human development is a continuous, lifelong process shaped by the interaction of biological, cognitive, emotional, social, cultural, environmental, and spiritual influences. Understanding development across the lifespan enables helping professionals to recognize that individuals cannot be understood solely by their age, behavior, diagnosis, or present circumstances. Each person brings a unique developmental history shaped by relationships, experiences, culture, environment, strengths, challenges, and opportunities for growth. For this major final assignment, students will demonstrate their understanding of the major concepts and developmental theories studied throughout the Human Growth and Development course. Students will create and analyze a comprehensive lifespan case that follows one fictional individual through major developmental stages and applies developmental theory to real-life experiences. The assignment will emphasize developmental theory, holistic development, resilience, relationships, cultural competence, ethical practice, spirituality, and professional helping relationships.

Assignment Title The Journey of Human Development: A Comprehensive Lifespan Case Analysis

Assignment Requirements Prepare a 3,000–3,500-word academic paper examining the developmental journey of a fictional individual from childhood through later adulthood. Your paper should demonstrate how development changes across the lifespan while also showing how earlier experiences may influence later development. Students should integrate developmental theory with practical professional application. The assignment must use appropriate section headings, but every section must be written in complete, well-developed paragraph form rather than bullet points.

Section 1: Introduction and Individual Profile Introduce the fictional individual whose developmental journey you will examine. Provide relevant background information concerning the person's family, culture, community, socioeconomic environment, relationships, educational experiences, and other important circumstances. Explain why human development should be understood as a continuous process rather than a collection of unrelated stages. Conclude your introduction by explaining the purpose of your lifespan case analysis and identifying the major developmental areas that will be examined.

Section 2: Childhood Development Analyze your individual's development during childhood. Discuss important biological, cognitive, emotional, and social developments occurring during this period. Consider the influence of caregivers, family relationships, school experiences, friendships, community environment, culture, and other factors. Identify significant experiences that may have contributed positively or negatively to the child's development. Discuss the importance of healthy relationships and supportive environments during childhood and explain how these early experiences may influence later development.

Section

3: Adolescent Development and Identity Examine the individual's transition into adolescence. Discuss the physical, cognitive, emotional, and social changes occurring during this developmental period. Analyze the individual's developing identity, independence, peer relationships, family relationships, educational experiences, decision-making, and emotional development. Apply an appropriate developmental theory to explain the individual's experiences. Discuss how family, peers, culture, community, and environmental circumstances influence the adolescent's developing identity and preparation for adulthood.

Section 4: Early Adulthood Analyze the individual's development during early adulthood. Discuss major developmental responsibilities involving independence, relationships, career development, education, financial responsibility, emotional maturity, and personal decision-making. Apply Erikson's concept of Intimacy versus Isolation and explain how the individual's ability to establish meaningful relationships influences development. Discuss how experiences from childhood and adolescence may continue to influence adult relationships, coping patterns, decisions, or self-concept.

Section 5: Middle Adulthood Examine the individual's development during middle adulthood. Consider career responsibilities, marriage or relationships, parenting when applicable, leadership, caregiving, physical changes, emotional maturity, work-life balance, and changing personal priorities. Apply Erikson's concept of Generativity versus Stagnation. Analyze how the individual contributes to other people through parenting, mentoring, professional service, leadership, ministry, community participation, volunteering, or other meaningful activities. Discuss how purpose and contribution can influence life satisfaction during middle adulthood.

Section 6: Later Adulthood and Aging Analyze the individual's transition into later adulthood. Discuss physical changes, cognitive development, retirement or changing professional roles, family relationships, social connections, health, independence, spirituality, and adaptation to aging. Apply Erikson's concept of Integrity versus Despair. Explain how the individual reflects upon life experiences, accomplishments, relationships, disappointments, purpose, and legacy. Discuss factors that may contribute to healthy aging and continued quality of life.

Section 7: Biological, Cognitive, and Emotional Development Across the Lifespan Examine how the individual's biological, cognitive, and emotional development changed throughout life. Rather than discussing each stage separately again, identify important patterns. For example, explain how physical health, cognitive abilities, emotional regulation, coping skills, decision-making, or self-awareness developed or changed over time. Discuss how these areas of development interacted with one another rather than occurring independently.

Section 8: Social, Cultural, and Environmental Influences Analyze how the individual's development was influenced by the surrounding environment. Discuss important influences such as family, friendships, education, employment, community, socioeconomic circumstances, culture, social expectations, available resources, and significant life events. Demonstrate cultural competence by recognizing that developmental experiences can differ according to cultural and environmental circumstances. Explain why helping professionals should avoid assuming that every individual follows exactly the same developmental pathway.

Section 9: Resilience

Across the Lifespan Identify significant challenges or adversities your fictional individual experienced. These could involve family difficulties, educational challenges, financial hardship, relationship problems, career setbacks, illness, discrimination, grief, major transitions, or other realistic circumstances. Analyze the individual's risk factors and protective factors. Explain how supportive relationships, coping strategies, education, community resources, self-efficacy, spirituality, professional services, or other resources contributed to resilience. Discuss why resilience does not mean that a person is unaffected by adversity. Instead, explain how resilience involves the developing capacity to adapt, seek support, use resources, and continue moving forward.

Section 10: Healthy Relationships and Human Development Analyze the importance of relationships throughout the individual's lifespan. Discuss how relationships with parents, caregivers, siblings, peers, teachers, partners, spouses, children, coworkers, mentors, community members, or others influenced development. Explain how healthy relationships can provide security, belonging, emotional support, guidance, encouragement, accountability, and opportunities for growth. Also examine how unhealthy relationships could negatively influence development. Discuss why helping professionals should consider an individual's social-support network when developing interventions or support plans.

Section 11: Spiritual Development and Holistic Care Analyze the role of spirituality or faith within human development for individuals who value it. Discuss how spirituality may contribute to identity, meaning, purpose, hope, relationships, coping, service, and responses to major life transitions. From a Christian perspective, explain how human dignity, compassion, service, stewardship, forgiveness, and concern for others can influence helping relationships. Include at least three relevant Scripture passages and explain their practical relationship to human development and compassionate care. The biblical discussion should be integrated thoughtfully rather than simply presenting Scripture quotations.

Section 12: Ethical Practice and Cultural Competence Discuss the responsibilities of professionals who work with individuals at different developmental stages. Analyze the importance of confidentiality, professional boundaries, respect, informed decision-making, cultural sensitivity, professional competence, appropriate referral, and protection of vulnerable individuals. Explain why professionals must understand their own limitations and recognize when additional professional assistance is necessary. Discuss how cultural competence and cultural humility can prevent professionals from imposing their personal beliefs or expectations upon clients.

Section 13: Professional Helping Plan Imagine that you are a helping professional working with the individual at three different stages of life. Select three developmental stages and explain what type of support would be appropriate at each stage. For each stage, identify the individual's developmental needs, strengths, challenges, protective factors, and appropriate resources. Explain how your professional approach would change according to the individual's developmental stage. Your analysis should demonstrate that effective helping relationships are developmentally appropriate, individualized, ethical, culturally responsive, and strengths-based.

Section 14: Personal and Professional Reflection Conclude the assignment with a thoughtful reflection

on what you have learned throughout the Human Growth and Development course. Within your reflection, address the following questions in paragraph form: How has this course changed the way I understand human behavior? Why is it important to understand a person's developmental history rather than focusing only on present behavior? How can relationships and environments influence development? Why are resilience and protective factors important when working with individuals experiencing adversity? How can I demonstrate cultural competence when working with people whose backgrounds differ from mine? How will knowledge of human growth and development influence my future professional practice? Conclude by explaining what holistic care means to you and how you intend to recognize the biological, cognitive, emotional, social, cultural, environmental, and spiritual dimensions of the individuals you serve. Research Requirements Students must use a minimum of eight credible scholarly or professional sources related to human growth and development. Research should include relevant developmental theories and scholarly information concerning lifespan development, resilience, relationships, culture, aging, or professional helping practice. Biblical references may be included in addition to the required scholarly sources but do not count toward the eight-source requirement. All sources must be appropriately cited within the paper and included on the reference page. Formatting Requirements The final assignment must be 3,000–3,500 words, excluding the title and reference pages. Students must use APA 7th edition, double spacing, a 12-point academic font, appropriate section headings, in-text citations, and a complete reference page. All sections must be written in complete academic paragraph form. Bullet-point responses will not satisfy the assignment requirements.

 Due in 6 days (Sep 3, 11:59 PM)

 200 pts

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